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一、文章中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文围绕《引爆点》中“有影响力人士主导社会流行潮”的核心观点展开，先介绍了该观点的理论来源——“两级传播理论”，随后通过研究者的最新发现反驳了上述传统观点，最终指出：社会流行潮的广泛传播，核心并非少数有影响力的特殊人士，而是大量易受影响的普通人群形成的临界规模，以及影响力在人群中的连锁传递。

英文主旨

This article starts with the core view proposed in *The Tipping Point* that "social epidemics" are mainly driven by a tiny minority of influential people. It first introduces the theoretical source of this view, the "two-step flow of communication" theory, then refutes the above traditional view with the latest findings of researchers, and finally points out that the core of the widespread spread of social epidemics is not a few influential special people, but a critical mass of easily influenced ordinary people and the chain transmission of influence among the crowd.

二、逐句解析（分段落）

第一段

句1

- **原文：** In his book *The Tipping Point*, Malcolm Gladwell argues that "social epidemics" are driven in large part by the actions of a tiny minority of special individuals, often called influentials, who are unusually informed, persuasive, or well connected.
- **译文：** 马尔科姆·格拉德威尔在其《引爆点》一书中提出，“社会流行潮”在很大程度上是由极少数特殊个体的行为推动的；这些人通常被称为有影响力人士，他们见多识广、能言善辩，或是拥有极广的人脉。
- **常考单词&短语：**
 - epidemic n. 流行病；（风尚等的）流行，传播
 - in large part 在很大程度上
 - tiny minority 极少数
 - influential n. 有影响力的人物 adj. 有影响力的
 - informed adj. 见多识广的；了解情况的
 - persuasive adj. 有说服力的；能言善辩的
 - well connected 人脉广的；有良好社会关系的
- **长难句分析：**

本句为多层复合句，主句主干为 *Malcolm Gladwell argues that...*；

 1. that引导宾语从句，从句主干为 “social epidemics” are driven in large part by the actions...，是被动语态结构；
 2. often called influentials 是过去分词短语作后置定语，修饰先行词 individuals；
 3. who引导非限制性定语从句，同样修饰 individuals，补充说明这类特殊个体的核心特征。

句2

- **原文:** The idea is intuitively compelling, but it doesn't explain how ideas actually spread.
 - **译文:** 这个观点在直觉上很有说服力, 但它无法解释思想究竟是如何传播的。
 - **常考单词&短语:**
 - intuitively adv. 直觉上; 直观地
 - compelling adj. 令人信服的; 有说服力的
 - spread v. 传播; 蔓延; 扩散
-

第二段

句1

- **原文:** The supposed importance of influentials derives from a plausible-sounding but largely untested theory called the "two-step flow of communication": Information flows from the media to the influentials and from them to everyone else.
- **译文:** 有影响力人士的所谓重要性, 源于一个听起来合理但在很大程度上未经检验的理论——“两级传播理论”: 信息从媒体流向有影响力人士, 再从他们流向其他所有人。
- **常考单词&短语:**
 - supposed adj. 所谓的; 假定的
 - derive from 源自; 来源于
 - plausible-sounding adj. 听起来合理的
 - untested adj. 未经检验的; 未经验证的
 - two-step flow of communication 两级传播理论 (传播学核心术语)
 - flow v. 流动; 传播 n. 流量; 流动
- **长难句分析:**

主句主干为 *The supposed importance...derives from a...theory...*;

 1. *called the "two-step flow of communication"* 是过去分词短语作后置定语, 修饰 *theory*;
 2. 冒号后的内容为同位语, 对“两级传播理论”的核心内涵进行解释说明。

句2

- **原文:** Marketers have embraced the two-step flow because it suggests that if they can just find and influence the influentials, those select people will do most of the work for them.
- **译文:** 营销人员已经接纳了两级传播理论, 因为该理论表明, 只要他们能找到并影响这些有影响力人士, 这些被选中的人就会替他们完成大部分的工作。
- **常考单词&短语:**
 - marketer n. 营销人员; 市场营销商
 - embrace v. 欣然接受; 接纳; 拥抱
 - select adj. 精选的; 挑选出来的 v. 选择; 挑选

句3

- **原文:** The theory also seems to explain the sudden and unexpected popularity of certain looks, brands, or neighborhoods.
- **译文:** 该理论似乎也能解释某些穿搭风格、品牌或是社区突然出人意料地走红的现象。
- **常考单词&短语:**
 - unexpected adj. 意外的; 出人意料的
 - popularity n. 流行; 普及; 受欢迎度

- look n. 穿搭风格; 样貌; 样子
- brand n. 品牌
- neighborhood n. 社区; 街区; 邻里

句4

- **原文:** In many such cases, a cursory search for causes finds that some small group of people was wearing, promoting, or developing whatever it is before anyone else paid attention.
- **译文:** 在很多这类情形中, 粗略调查其原因就会发现, 总有一小群人在其他人留意到之前, 就已经在穿戴、推广或是开发这些东西了。
- **常考单词&短语:**
 - in many such cases 在很多这类情形中
 - cursory adj. 粗略的; 仓促的; 草率的
 - promote v. 推广; 宣传; 促进; 提升
 - pay attention 留意; 关注; 注意
- **长难句分析:**
主句主干为 *a cursory search...finds that...*;
 1. that引导宾语从句, 从句主干为 *some small group of people was wearing, promoting, or developing whatever it is*;
 2. whatever引导宾语从句, 作 *developing* 的宾语;
 3. before引导时间状语从句, 修饰前文的一系列动作, 明确动作发生的时间先后。

句5

- **原文:** Anecdotal evidence of this kind fits nicely with the idea that only certain special people can drive trends.
- **译文:** 这类轶事证据与“只有某些特殊人物才能推动潮流”的观点高度契合。
- **常考单词&短语:**
 - anecdotal adj. 轶事的; 传闻的
 - evidence n. 证据; 证明; 迹象
 - fit nicely with 与.....高度契合; 与.....十分吻合
 - drive trends 引领潮流; 推动趋势

第三段

句1

- **原文:** In their recent work, however, some researchers have come up with the finding that influentials have far less impact on social epidemics than is generally supposed.
- **译文:** 然而, 一些研究者在近期的研究中发现, 有影响力人士对社会流行潮的影响远比人们普遍认为的要小得多。
- **常考单词&短语:**
 - come up with 提出; 想出; 得出
 - have impact on 对.....产生影响
 - far less 远不及; 少得多
 - generally adv. 普遍地; 通常; 一般地
 - suppose v. 认为; 假定; 设想
- **长难句分析:**
主句主干为 *some researchers have come up with the finding...*;

1. that引导同位语从句，解释说明 *finding* 的具体内容；
2. 同位语从句中包含than引导的比较状语从句，*than is generally supposed* 是考研高频的比较状语省略结构，完整形式为 *than what is generally supposed by people*。

句2

- **原文：**In fact, they don't seem to be required at all.
- **译文：**事实上，社会流行潮似乎根本就不需要他们。
- **常考单词&短语：**
 - in fact 事实上；实际上
 - not...at all 根本不；一点也不
 - require v. 需要；要求；依赖

第四段

句1

- **原文：**The researchers' argument stems from a simple observation about social influence: With the exception of a few celebrities like Oprah Winfrey – whose outsize presence is primarily a function of media, not interpersonal, influence – even the most influential members of a population simply don't interact with that many others.
- **译文：**研究者的观点源于对社会影响力的一个简单观察：除了奥普拉·温弗瑞这类少数名人之外——他们的巨大影响力主要来自媒体效应，而非人际影响力——即便是一个群体中最具影响力的人，也根本不会和那么多的人交往。
- **常考单词&短语：**
 - stem from 源于；来自
 - observation n. 观察；观测；评论
 - with the exception of 除了.....之外
 - celebrity n. 名人；名流
 - outsize adj. 超大的；巨大的
 - presence n. 影响力；存在感；存在
 - primarily adv. 主要地；根本地
 - interpersonal adj. 人际的；人与人之间的
 - interact with 与.....交往；与.....互动

- **长难句分析：**

主句主干为 *The researchers' argument stems from a simple observation...*;

1. 冒号后的内容为同位语，完整解释 *observation* 的核心内容；
2. 两个破折号之间是whose引导的非限制性定语从句，修饰先行词 *Oprah Winfrey*，补充说明其影响力的来源；
3. 冒号后句子的主干为 *even the most influential members...don't interact with that many others*。

句2

- **原文：**Yet it is precisely these non-celebrity influentials who, according to the two-step-flow theory, are supposed to drive social epidemics by influencing their friends and colleagues directly.
- **译文：**然而，根据两级传播理论，恰恰是这些非名人的有影响力人士，应该通过直接影响他们的朋友和同事来推动社会流行潮。
- **常考单词&短语：**

- precisely adv. 恰恰；正好；精确地
- non-celebrity adj. 非名人的 n. 非名人
- be supposed to 应该；被期望
- colleague n. 同事；同僚
- directly adv. 直接地；径直地

• **长难句分析：**

本句为考研高频的 *it is...who...* 强调句，被强调的部分是句子主语 *these non-celebrity influentials*；

1. *according to the two-step-flow theory* 是插入语，作状语；
2. 句子谓语部分为 *are supposed to drive...*；
3. *by* 引导的介词短语作方式状语，说明推动社会流行潮的具体方式。

句3

- **原文：**For a social epidemic to occur, however, each person so affected must then influence his or her own acquaintances, who must in turn influence theirs, and so on; and just how many others pay attention to each of these people has little to do with the initial influential.
- **译文：**然而，要让一场社会流行潮发生，每个受到影响的人都必须接着去影响自己的熟人，这些熟人又必须反过来去影响他们的熟人，以此类推；而有多少人会关注这些人，与最初的有影响力人士几乎没有关系。

• **常考单词&短语：**

- occur v. 发生；出现；存在
- affected adj. 受到影响的；被打动的
- acquaintance n. 熟人；相识的人
- in turn 反过来；依次；轮流
- and so on 以此类推；等等
- have little to do with 与.....几乎无关
- initial adj. 最初的；初始的；开头的

• **长难句分析：**

本句是由分号连接的并列复合句，分为前后两个分句：

1. 前半句主干为 *each person...must then influence his or her own acquaintances*；*so affected* 是过去分词作后置定语修饰 *person*；*who* 引导非限制性定语从句，修饰先行词 *acquaintances*；
2. 后半句的主语是 *how* 引导的主语从句 *just how many others pay attention to each of these people*，谓语为 *has little to do with*，宾语为 *the initial influential*。

句4

- **原文：**If people in the network just two degrees removed from the initial influential prove resistant, for example, the cascade of change won't propagate very far or affect many people.
- **译文：**例如，假如在这个传播网络中，与最初的有影响力人士相隔两个层级的人抵制这种影响，那么这一连串的变化就不会传播得很远，也不会影响到很多人。

• **常考单词&短语：**

- network n. 网络；网状系统；人际网
- removed from 与.....相隔；远离
- resistant adj. 抵抗的；抵制的；有抵抗力的
- cascade n. 一连串；瀑布；级联
- propagate v. 传播；宣传；繁殖

• **长难句分析：**

本句为复合句，*if* 引导条件状语从句；

1. 从句主干为 *people...prove resistant; in the network* 和 *just two degrees removed from the initial influential* 均为后置定语，修饰 *people*;
 2. *for example* 是插入语;
 3. 主句主干为 *the cascade of change won't propagate...or affect...*，包含两个并列的谓语动词。
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第五段

句1

- **原文**: Building on this basic truth about interpersonal influence, the researchers studied the dynamics of social influence by conducting thousands of computer simulations of populations, manipulating a number of variables relating to people's ability to influence others and their tendency to be influenced.
- **译文**: 基于这一人际影响力的基本事实，研究者们通过对人群进行数千次计算机模拟，控制了一系列与人们影响他人的能力和被他人影响的倾向相关的变量，研究了社会影响力的动态变化。
- **常考单词&短语**:
 - build on 基于；以.....为基础；依靠
 - dynamics n. 动态；动力学；动态变化
 - conduct v. 进行；实施；引导；组织
 - simulation n. 模拟；仿真
 - manipulate v. 控制；操纵；操作
 - variable n. 变量；可变因素 adj. 可变的；多变的
 - relate to 与.....相关；涉及
 - tendency n. 倾向；趋势；偏好
- **长难句分析**:

主句主干为 *the researchers studied the dynamics of social influence*;

 1. 句首的 *Building on...* 是现在分词短语作原因状语;
 2. *by conducting...* 是介词短语作方式状语，说明研究的实施方式;
 3. *manipulating...* 是现在分词短语作伴随状语，补充说明模拟过程中的核心操作;
 4. *relating to...* 是现在分词短语作后置定语，修饰 *variables*，说明变量的关联维度。

句2

- **原文**: They found that the principal requirement for what is called "global cascades" – the widespread propagation of influence through networks – is the presence not of a few influentials but, rather, of a critical mass of easily influenced people.
- **译文**: 他们发现，所谓的“全球级联传播”（即影响力通过人际网络广泛传播）的首要条件，并不是少数有影响力人士的存在，恰恰相反，是一大批易受影响的普通人的存在。
- **常考单词&短语**:
 - principal adj. 首要的；主要的
 - requirement n. 要求；必要条件；所需的东西
 - widespread adj. 广泛的；普遍的；分布广的
 - propagation n. 传播；繁殖；宣传
 - not...but... 不是.....而是.....
 - rather adv. 恰恰相反；相当
 - critical mass 临界数量；关键规模
 - a mass of 大量的；一大批
- **长难句分析**:

主句主干为 *They found that...*;

1. that引导宾语从句，从句主干为 *the principal requirement...is the presence...*;
2. *for what is called "global cascades"* 是介词短语作后置定语修饰 *requirement*，其中what引导宾语从句，作介词for的宾语；
3. 两个破折号之间的内容是同位语，解释说明“global cascades”的定义；
4. 从句表语部分用了考研高频的 *not...but...* 并列结构，连接两个of介词短语修饰 *presence*，明确核心条件的归属。

三、完整原文

In his book *The Tipping Point*, Malcolm Gladwell argues that “social epidemics” are driven in large part by the actions of a tiny minority of special individuals, often called influentials, who are unusually informed, persuasive, or well connected. The idea is intuitively compelling, but it doesn’t explain how ideas actually spread.

The supposed importance of influentials derives from a plausible-sounding but largely untested theory called the “two-step flow of communication”: Information flows from the media to the influentials and from them to everyone else. Marketers have embraced the two-step flow because it suggests that if they can just find and influence the influentials, those select people will do most of the work for them. The theory also seems to explain the sudden and unexpected popularity of certain looks, brands, or neighborhoods. In many such cases, a cursory search for causes finds that some small group of people was wearing, promoting, or developing whatever it is before anyone else paid attention. Anecdotal evidence of this kind fits nicely with the idea that only certain special people can drive trends.

In their recent work, however, some researchers have come up with the finding that influentials have far less impact on social epidemics than is generally supposed. In fact, they don’t seem to be required at all.

The researchers’ argument stems from a simple observation about social influence: With the exception of a few celebrities like Oprah Winfrey – whose outsize presence is primarily a function of media, not interpersonal, influence – even the most influential members of a population simply don’t interact with that many others. Yet it is precisely these non-celebrity influentials who, according to the two-step-flow theory, are supposed to drive social epidemics by influencing their friends and colleagues directly. For a social epidemic to occur, however, each person so affected must then influence his or her own acquaintances, who must in turn influence theirs, and so on; and just how many others pay attention to each of these people has little to do with the initial influential. If people in the network just two degrees removed from the initial influential prove resistant, for example, the cascade of change won’t propagate very far or affect many people.

Building on this basic truth about interpersonal influence, the researchers studied the dynamics of social influence by conducting thousands of computer simulations of populations, manipulating a number of variables relating to people’s ability to influence others and their tendency to be influenced. They found that the principal requirement for what is called “global cascades” – the widespread propagation of influence through networks – is the presence not of a few influentials but, rather, of a critical mass of easily influenced people.

四、完整译文

马尔科姆·格拉德威尔在其《引爆点》一书中提出，“社会流行潮”在很大程度上是由极少数特殊个体的行为推动的；这些人通常被称为有影响力人士，他们见多识广、能言善辩，或是拥有极广的人脉。这个观点在直觉上很有说服力，但它无法解释思想究竟是如何传播的。

有影响力人士的所谓重要性，源于一个听起来合理但在很大程度上未经检验的理论——“两级传播理论”：信息从媒体流向有影响力人士，再从他们流向其他所有人。营销人员已经接纳了两级传播理论，因为该理论表明，只要他们能找到并影响这些有影响力人士，这些被选中的人就会替他们完成大部分的工作。该理论似乎也能解释某些穿搭风格、品牌或是社区突然出人意料地走红的现象。在很多这类情形中，粗略调查其原因就会发现，总有一小群人在其他人留意到之前，就已经在穿戴、推广或是开发这些东西了。这类轶事证据与“只有某些特殊人物才能推动潮流”的观点高度契合。

然而，一些研究者在近期的研究中发现，有影响力人士对社会流行潮的影响远比人们普遍认为的要小得多。事实上，社会流行潮似乎根本就不需要他们。

研究者的观点源于对社会影响力的一个简单观察：除了奥普拉·温弗瑞这类少数名人之外——他们的巨大影响力主要来自媒体效应，而非人际影响力——即便是一个群体中最具影响力的人，也根本不会和那么多的人交往。然而，根据两级传播理论，恰恰是这些非名人的有影响力人士，应该通过直接影响他们的朋友和同事来推动社会流行潮。然而，要让一场社会流行潮发生，每个受到影响的人都必须接着去影响自己的熟人，这些熟人又必须反过来去影响他们的熟人，以此类推；而有多少人会关注这些人，与最初的有影响力人士几乎没有关系。例如，假如在这个传播网络中，与最初的有影响力人士相隔两个层级的人抵制这种影响，那么这一连串的变化就不会传播得很远，也不会影响到很多人。

基于这一人际影响力的基本事实，研究者们通过对人群进行数千次计算机模拟，控制了一系列与人们影响他人的能力和被他人影响的倾向相关的变量，研究了社会影响力的动态变化。他们发现，所谓的“全球级联传播”（即影响力通过人际网络广泛传播）的首要条件，并不是少数有影响力人士的存在，恰恰相反，是一大批易受影响的普通人的存在。